

20 Youth Icebreaker & Energizer Activities

Ready-to-run activities for groups of 10 to 100: openers, energizers, team challenges and a closing. Each one with time, materials, steps, and a debrief tip. Activity names in English, French and Arabic.

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Icebreaker or energizer?

Icebreakers help people meet and feel safe at the start. **Energizers** bring attention back when energy drops, usually after lunch or a long sitting block. Using the wrong one at the wrong moment is the most common mistake: a long getting-to-know-you game at 3 pm kills energy instead of raising it.

Three rules: link the activity to the session's theme when you can; always explain why you are doing it; and adapt anything physical to the group's comfort, culture and abilities. Nobody should feel forced to participate.

01 Two Truths and a Lie

Deux vérités, un mensonge · حقيقتان وكذبة

Icebreaker 10-30 people 15-20 min

Materials: None

1. Each person shares three statements about themselves: two true, one false.
2. The group guesses which one is the lie.
3. Keep it moving: 30-40 seconds per person.

Tip: Ask for statements linked to the workshop theme (e.g. a leadership moment) to warm up the topic too.

02 Human Bingo

Bingo humain · بينغو بشري

Icebreaker 15-60 people 15 min

Materials: Printed 4×4 grids, pens

1. Each grid square holds a trait: 'speaks three languages', 'has organised an event'...
2. Participants find a different person for each square and write their name.
3. First full line shouts 'Bingo' and introduces the people they met.

Tip: Write traits that reveal useful skills in the room, not just fun facts.

03 Silent Line-Up

La ligne silencieuse · الصف الصامت

Icebreaker 10-40 people 10 min

Materials: None

1. The group lines up by birthday (day and month) without speaking.
2. Gestures are allowed, words are not.
3. Check the order out loud at the end.

Tip: Debrief: how did you communicate without words? Who took the lead?

04 Common Ground

Points communs · نقاط مشتركة

Icebreaker 8-30 people 10 min

Materials: None

1. Groups of 3-4 have 5 minutes to find 5 things they all have in common.
2. Nothing obvious (no 'we are all here').
3. Each group shares its most surprising one.

Tip: Great to form working groups that will stay together for the day.

05 Name and Gesture

Prénom et geste · الاسم والحركة

Icebreaker 8-25 people 10 min

Materials: None

1. In a circle, each person says their name with a gesture.
2. The whole group repeats the name and gesture.
3. Second round: try to remember everyone's.

Tip: Helps names stick on day one, especially in trilingual groups.

06 Speed Networking

Speed networking · التعارف السريع

Icebreaker 10-60 people 15-20 min

Materials: Timer, question list

1. Two lines face each other in pairs.
2. Each pair answers one question for 2 minutes.
3. One line moves one step; new partner, new question.

Tip: Use questions linked to the workshop: 'What would you change in your organisation?'

07 The Wind Blows

Le vent souffle · تهبّ الرياح

Energizer 12-35 people 10 min

Materials: Chairs in a circle, one fewer than people

1. One person stands in the middle: 'The wind blows for everyone who...' (e.g. has a sister).
2. Everyone it applies to changes seat.
3. The person left standing goes to the middle next.

Tip: Keep statements inclusive; avoid anything that singles out personal situations.

08 Map of Origins

La carte des origines · خريطة الأصول

Icebreaker 10-60 people 10 min

Materials: Open floor space

1. Describe an imaginary map on the floor (Tunis in the north, Sfax...).
2. Participants stand where they were born, then where they live now.
3. Ask a few people to share a word about their place.

Tip: Shows the group's diversity visually in two minutes.

09 Paper Plane Questions

Avions en papier · أسئلة الطائرات الورقية

Icebreaker 10-50 people 15 min

Materials: A4 paper, pens

1. Everyone writes a question on paper and folds a plane.
2. All planes fly at once.
3. Pick up any plane, find someone you don't know, answer each other's questions.

Tip: Works well before a session on expectations: 'What do you hope to learn today?'

10 Zip Zap Boing

Zip Zap Boing · زيب زاب بوينغ

Energizer 10-30 people 5-10 min

Materials: None

1. In a circle, 'zip' passes the energy to your neighbour, 'zap' across the circle.
2. 'Boing' with hands up bounces it back.
3. Speed up; mistakes are part of the fun.

Tip: Perfect after lunch or after a long sitting block.

11 Count to 20

Compter jusqu'à 20 · العدّ إلى عشرين

Energizer 8-25 people 5-10 min

Materials: None

1. The group counts to 20, one number per person, in random order.
2. If two people speak at once, start again from 1.
3. No pattern or turn-taking allowed.

Tip: Debrief on listening and patience: it is a team-focus exercise.

12 Mirror

Le miroir · المرأة

Energizer Pairs people 5-10 min

Materials: None

1. Pairs face each other; one leads slow movements, the other mirrors.
2. Switch roles after one minute.
3. Third round: no leader, try to move together.

Tip: Opens a session on active listening and non-verbal communication.

13 Atoms

Les atomes · الذرات

Energizer 15-100 people 5 min

Materials: None

1. Everyone walks around the room.
2. The facilitator calls a number: people group in atoms of that size.
3. End on the group size you need for the next activity.

Tip: A fun way to form random groups without counting off.

14 Back-to-Back Drawing

Dessin dos à dos · الرسم ظهرًا لظهر

Icebreaker Pairs people 15 min

Materials: Paper, pens, simple images

1. Pairs sit back to back; one gets a simple image.
2. They describe it without naming it; the other draws.
3. Compare drawings, then switch.

Tip: Debrief: what made instructions clear or confusing? Strong opener for communication training.

15 Rock-Paper-Scissors Tournament

Tournoi pierre-feuille-ciseaux · بطولة حجر ورقة مقص

Energizer 15-100 people 5-10 min

Materials: None

1. Everyone plays one round with a neighbour.
2. The loser becomes the winner's cheerleader and follows them.
3. Winners face each other until two big teams cheer the final.

Tip: Ends with the whole room laughing and loud: ideal reset.

16 Story Chain

Histoire en chaîne · القصة المتسلسلة

Energizer 8-25 people 10 min

Materials: None

1. The facilitator starts a story with one sentence.
2. Each person adds one sentence around the circle.
3. Optional: the story must include the day's theme.

Tip: Builds creativity and listening; useful before brainstorming.

17 Stand Up If...

قف إذا... · Levez-vous si...

Icebreaker 10-100 people 5-10 min

Materials: List of statements

1. Read statements: 'Stand up if you have volunteered before'.
2. People stand, look around, sit down.
3. Move from light statements to theme-related ones.

Tip: Gives you a quick profile of the room before you start.

18 Marshmallow Challenge

تحدي المارشملو · Défi marshmallow

Team challenge Teams of 3-5 people 25 min

Materials: Per team: 20 spaghetti, 1 m tape, 1 m string, 1 marshmallow

1. Teams build the tallest free-standing tower in 18 minutes.
2. The marshmallow must sit on top.
3. Measure, then debrief.

Tip: Debrief on planning vs. testing early: teams that prototype usually win.

19 Human Knot

Le nœud humain · العقدة البشرية

Team challenge 8-12 per group people 10-15 min

Materials: None

1. In a circle, each person takes two different hands across the circle.
2. Without letting go, the group untangles into one circle.
3. Debrief on leadership and coordination.

Tip: Involves holding hands: check the group's comfort first and offer a no-contact role (observer, guide).

20 One-Word Check-Out

كلمة للختام · Un mot pour finir

Closing Any people 5 min

Materials: None

1. In a circle, each person says one word describing how they leave the session.
2. No comments, just listen.
3. The facilitator closes with their own word.

Tip: Simple, respectful closing that also gives you instant feedback.